

SECURITY STANDARDS

Password & Authentication Standard

The measurable rules behind 'strong passwords + MFA'.

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Standard

1. Length first

Minimum 14 characters for users, 20 for admins/service accounts; passphrases encouraged; complexity theater avoided.

2. Breached-password screening

New and reset passwords screen against known-breach lists; matches are rejected.

3. MFA

Required for email, identity, VPN, remote access, admin tools, and finance systems; app-based or hardware-key methods preferred over SMS.

4. Storage

Passwords live only in the managed vault - never in spreadsheets, notes, or browsers on shared machines.

5. Rotation

Rotate on compromise indicators and personnel change, not on arbitrary calendars; service accounts rotate at least annually.

6. Lockout

10 failed attempts locks for 15 minutes with alerting on bursts.

Compliance

Deviations require a written exception (BVT-FRM-267) with compensating controls and an expiration date. This standard is reviewed annually.